

MARCELO RONDON

PRODUCT DESIGNER, HUMAN-CENTERED AI SYSTEMS

🌐 Portland, Oregon 🌐

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ABOUT

Product designer building human-centered AI systems that augment creative workflows without replacing human judgment. I bridge design and engineering by turning real workflows into working tools with bounded automation, editable states, validation, accessibility, and clear handoff intent. Recent work includes Ghosted, an AI-assisted job-application product, and Daybreak, a local-first Mac and iPhone planner with a typed, receipt-backed agent layer.

EXPERIENCE

Asheville Dispensary PRODUCT DESIGN LEAD / DESIGN ENGINEER

2022 – Present

Asheville, NC (Remote)

- Own product design across web, print, and packaging, anchored by a Figma design system that keeps the brand coherent as the product line grows.
- Designed and built an internal asset-management tool in React, TypeScript, and Tailwind CSS that gives marketing and operations one place to find, manage, and preserve brand assets.
- Design and ship reusable UI components into WordPress through custom PHP and JavaScript plugins, closing the gap between mockups and production.
- Partner with marketing and operations to turn ambiguous requests into scoped, shipped product surfaces.

VegAvengers Marketing PRODUCT DESIGNER / FRONT-END ENGINEER

2025 – Present

Freelance project

- Designed and shipped a responsive discovery experience with flexible search across VegFests, animal sanctuaries, locations, dates, months, and changing event states.
- Evolved the product into a hybrid Astro and Payload architecture: prerendered editorial pages, live resource-search APIs, and a headless CMS backed by Postgres with media in Cloudflare R2.
- Defined debounced, selective rebuild policies plus fixture and Astro DB fallback paths so content changes avoid unnecessary deploys and the public experience degrades safely if Payload is unavailable.

Cello.Design INDEPENDENT PRODUCT DESIGNER

2022 – Present

Independent product design and accessibility practice. Selected engagements:

- The Green Phial: redesigned and maintained the WordPress storefront, translating brand direction into responsive, accessible front-end implementation with improved performance and SEO.
- Accessibility consulting: improved WCAG 2.1 compliance for multiple organizations, including River Phoenix Center for Peacebuilding, covering screen-reader behavior, keyboard navigation, and performance.
- Legal Impact for Chickens: built secure internal tooling for data-management workflows, handling confidential materials with discretion.
- Ghosted: designed and built an AI-assisted job-application product – a Go terminal prototype rewritten into a shipped Next.js/TypeScript web app, where deterministic code does the work and a single bounded, code-validated model call writes the prose; 744 tests.

Mantera Advertising Agency SENIOR BRAND DESIGNER

2021 – 2022

Remote

- Designed campaign and marketing materials for retail clients under tight deadlines.
- Worked directly with clients through fast iteration cycles, clarifying goals and constraints while protecting quality and delivery dates.

Success Academy Charter Schools
LEARNING EXPERIENCE DESIGNER / TEACHER

2020 – 2021

New York, NY (Remote)

- Designed remote learning experiences for ELA and math using structured learning frameworks.
- Produced educational content and visual aids, applying design thinking to improve comprehension and engagement.

The Fine Print Magazine
VISUAL STORYTELLING LEAD / PHOTO EDITOR

2017 – 2019

Gainesville, FL

- Led a team of photographers and directed visual coverage for editorial stories and events.
- Developed visual direction for fundraising events, using photography and design to improve visibility and engagement.

SKILLS

HTML CSS JAVASCRIPT TYPESCRIPT REACT TAILWIND GIT WORDPRESS PHP MYSQL FIGMA AI PRODUCT DESIGN
SWIFTUI / SWIFTDATA PHOTOSHOP ILLUSTRATOR AFTER EFFECTS PREMIERE PYTHON GO

PROJECTS

Ghosted

2026

Designed and built an AI-assisted job-application workspace – from a Go terminal prototype to a shipped web product where deterministic code does the work and one bounded model call writes the prose.

- Rewrote a Go TUI prototype into a live Next.js/TypeScript web product with posting capture, deterministic fit scoring, and ATS-validated PDF export
- Designed the 'minimum viable intelligence' architecture: code parses, scores, and validates; the model only writes prose, checked against a 180-word cap, a banned-phrase list, and CV-grounded honesty flags
- Built a triage review UI (accept, reject, edit) and targeted revision so generated material is edited from, never pasted over
- Shipped to real testers on an invite-gated shared subscription, folding feedback into a synchronous double-fire guard and tighter layouts
- Backed by 744 tests across a pure-TypeScript core and a Next.js app

Daybreak

2026

Designed and built a local-first personal planning product for Mac and iPhone that combines a deterministic planning engine with agent-assisted adjustments while keeping the plan editable and the user in control.

- Shipped a shared SwiftUI and SwiftData app for macOS and iPhone with private CloudKit sync, without a product account or hosted application server
- Separated a pure, testable planning engine from the app layer so generated day plans obey explicit schedule, ownership, and local-day boundary rules
- Defined typed UI-agent parity contracts so agent-accessible actions match the product grammar, emit auditable receipts, and leave destructive or external actions behind explicit safety exclusions
- Kept automated planning inspectable and editable: people can review, move, defer, or remove Daybreak-owned blocks while source-owned calendar meetings remain protected
- Dogfooded the product against real planning and sync failures, turning trust problems into tested product rules across Mac and iPhone

EDUCATION

University of Florida
VISUAL JOURNALISM & COMMUNICATIONS

2016 – 2019

Minor: Digital Arts & Sciences